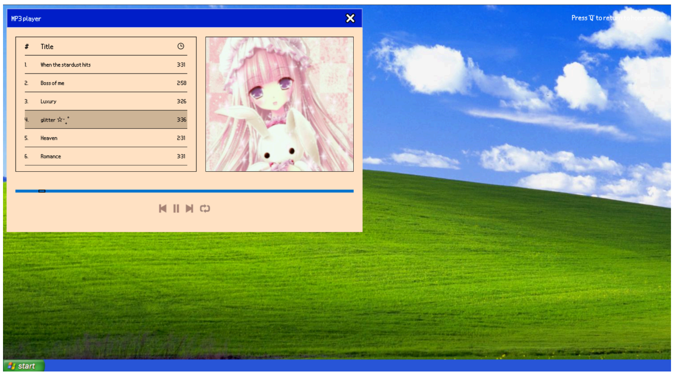
Rayvhaun Dougan-Gordon ID: 40319634
Kerven Laurent Casimir
CART 263 AA 2254

Artist Statement II

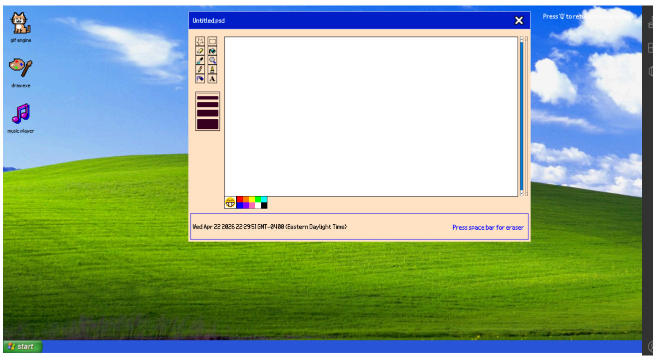
1. Desktop home screen inspired by Windows XP interfaces.

2. Interactive cat GIF application using the CATAAS API.



3. Music player using howler js library

Take a selfie app. (yes i broke my wrist)



4. Live paint where users can draw using Js and p5

This project explores nostalgia, interaction, and obsolete digital media through the recreation of an early 2000s desktop environment inside the browser. Inspired by older operating systems such as Windows XP, educational drawing software, and early media players, the project attempts to recreate the feeling of interacting with technologies that many users grew up with but that are now considered outdated or obsolete.

Using our background in design alongside the programming concepts learned throughout the course, we combined visual design principles with JavaScript interaction systems to create a fully interactive browser-based desktop experience. Unlike our first project, where all interactions existed on a single page simultaneously, this version separates each interaction into individual draggable applications. Users are able to open, close, and move between applications independently, creating a more realistic desktop-like user experience.

The project contains three main applications: a drawing program, a GIF generator, music player, and an active camera App!. The drawing application allows users to sketch, erase, and change colors using p5.js canvas functions translated into vanilla JavaScript. The GIF application uses the CATAAS API to generate random cat GIFs through user interaction, incorporating humor and references to early internet culture. The music player was built using the Howler.js library, which facilitated audio playback, track controls, looping, and playlist interaction. The songs and cover art used in the player were sourced from a personal SoundCloud playlist and integrated into the interface alongside MP3 files. The camera app allows users to use their own camera to capture images.

Several techniques and libraries were used throughout the project. p5.js was used to create the interactive drawing canvas, while Howler.js handled audio functionality and playback controls. Anime.js draggable components were also used to recreate movable desktop windows similar to older operating systems. Together, these tools helped merge design and interaction into a cohesive browser-based application environment.

Conceptually, the project continues our interest in “dead media” and media archaeology by revisiting interaction systems and interface styles that have slowly disappeared or evolved over time. Rather than simply replicating obsolete technologies, the project reimagines them through contemporary web technologies while preserving their nostalgic visual language and interaction patterns.

Reference 1

One of the biggest visual and conceptual inspirations for this project was early desktop operating systems, particularly the aesthetic and user experience of Windows XP. The draggable application windows, desktop icons, taskbar, and close buttons were all designed to mirror the structure and interaction style of early 2000s computer environments. Rather than creating a single webpage with fixed content, we wanted users to feel like they were entering and navigating a functioning desktop space. This approach helped reinforce our interest in nostalgia and dead media by recreating interaction patterns that many users grew up with but are now considered outdated or obsolete.

Reference 2

Another major inspiration for the project was MS Paint and early educational drawing applications from the late 1990s and early 2000s. These programs often introduced creativity through simple interfaces, limited tools, and playful interaction. We were inspired by how accessible and experimental these applications felt, especially for younger users learning how to interact with computers for the first time.

This influence can be seen directly in our drawing application, which includes a canvas, color palette, brush tools, eraser functionality, and draggable windows. Rather than focusing on advanced digital art tools, we intentionally embraced a simpler and more nostalgic interface that encourages experimentation and play. The project reinterprets these older drawing programs through modern web technologies such as p5.js and vanilla JavaScript, while still preserving the visual and interactive qualities that made those early applications memorable.

Together, these references helped shape both the visual identity and conceptual direction of the project by combining nostalgia, interaction, and media archaeology into a browser-based experience.